LESSON 2:
Methods of Philosophizing

Introduction to the Philosophy of the Human Person

SYSTEMS PLUS COMPUTER COLLEGE 1985
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COMMITMENT TO EXCELLENCE

What's Wrong with the Argument?

Almost everyone in our class copied answers during the online quiz. Since everyone did it, cheating shouldn't be considered wrong.

Don't listen to her opinion. She failed Philosophy last semester, so her argument can't possibly be correct.

We should choose Miguel. His family is experiencing financial difficulties, and they need the scholarship the most.

What's Wrong with the Argument?

Situation 1 – The Student Council Election

The Student Council is electing a new president.

Candidate A presents a detailed platform that includes improving the library, organizing academic support programs, and creating mental health initiatives.

Candidate B says during the campaign:
"Don't vote for Candidate A. Last year, he failed Mathematics. If he can't even pass Math, how can he become our student council president?"

Lesson: Fallacies
(Errors in Reasoning)

LEARNING TARGETS

At the end of the lesson, learners should be able to:

- Define fallacy
- Identify different kinds of fallacies
- Analyze arguments and determine the fallacy committed
- Construct sound arguments by avoiding logical fallacies



What is Fallacy?



What is Fallacy?




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Recognizing Errors in Reasoning

A **fallacy** is an error or defect in reasoning that weakens an argument.

A fallacy may:

sound convincing
appeal to emotions
misuse facts

jump to conclusions
distort the truth



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Why Study Fallacies?

Why Study Fallacies?







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Understanding fallacies helps us:

- ✔ Think critically
- ✔ Make better decisions
- ✔ Avoid manipulation
- ✔ Build stronger arguments
- ✔ Respect truth over opinion



What are the different fallacies?



Let's Analyze the Situation





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During the final grading period, a student approaches the teacher after receiving a failing grade.

The student says:

"Ma'am, please pass me. My father recently lost his job, and my mother is working overseas. If I fail this subject, I'll disappoint my family and lose my scholarship. Please give me a passing grade."



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Appeal to Pity (Argumentum ad Misericordiam)





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This fallacy occurs when someone tries to persuade others by **appealing to emotions—especially sympathy or guilt—instead of providing logical reasons or evidence.**

Create a fallacious argument:
You submitted your research paper three days late, and your teacher is deciding whether to deduct points.



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Let's Analyze the Situation





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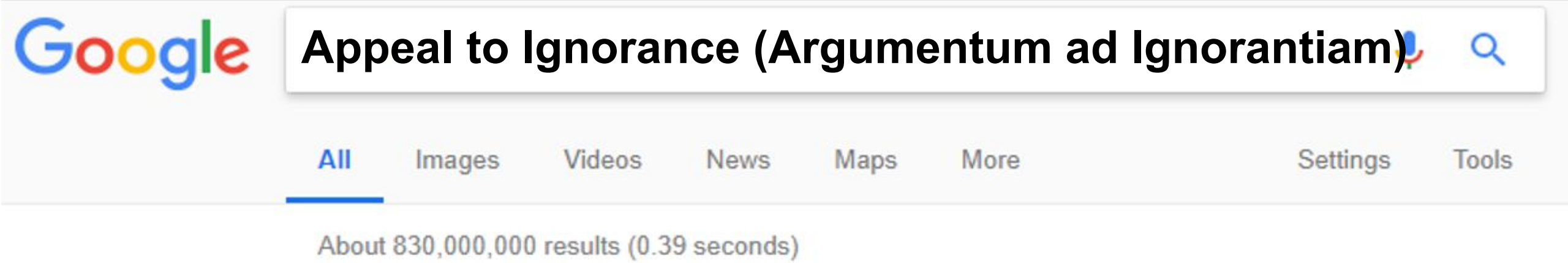
A social media post claims:

"Scientists have never proven that extraterrestrial life does not exist. Therefore, aliens are secretly living on Earth."



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Appeal to Ignorance (Argumentum ad Ignorantiam)



This fallacy occurs when someone claims that something is **true simply because it has not been proven false, or false because it has not been proven true.**

Create a fallacious argument:

- Someone claims a mysterious creature lives in the nearby mountains.
- A classmate says a new AI application secretly steals users' personal information.
- A student believes a lucky bracelet guarantees passing every examination.



Let's Analyze the Situation



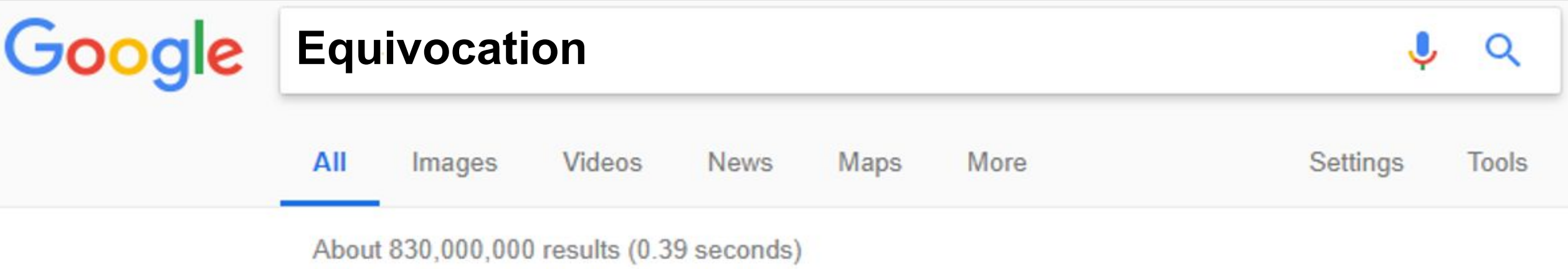


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During a debate, one student argues:

"Our school teaches students to have 'character.' Since characters exist in movies and video games, our school must also teach fictional characters."



This fallacy happens when **the same word or phrase is used with different meanings within the same argument**, causing confusion or leading to an incorrect conclusion.

Other Examples

- *Human beings have **hands**. A clock has **hands**. Therefore, a clock is a human being.*
- *He drinks water from a **pitcher**. He is a baseball **pitcher**.*

<u>Create a fallacious argument: values, ruler, head</u>



Let's Analyze the Situation




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A school's robotics team has five members. Each member has won an individual programming competition.

A student concludes:

"Since every member is an excellent programmer, our team will definitely win the National Robotics Competition."



Composition




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This fallacy assumes that **what is true of the individual parts must also be true of the whole.**

Create a fallacious argument
Every member of your debate team received high grades in English.
Every computer in the ICT laboratory is brand new.
Each member of a band is an excellent musician.



Let's Analyze the Situation





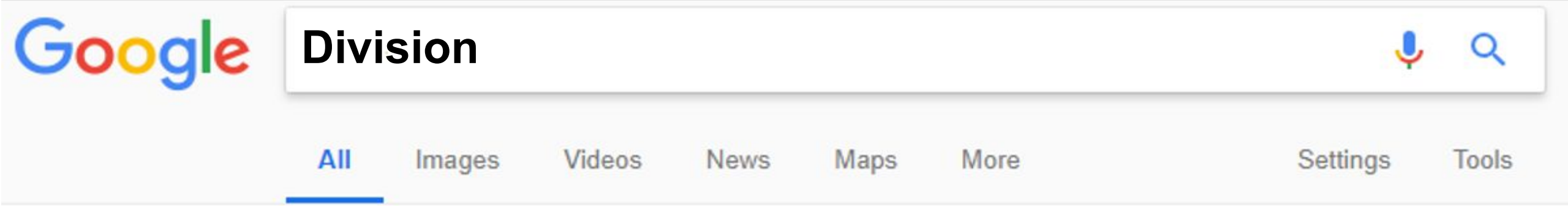
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A Senior High School receives the award for **"Best Performing School in the Region.“**

A parent proudly says:

"Since this is the best school, every student here must be academically excellent."



This fallacy assumes that **what is true of the whole must also be true of each individual part.**

Create a fallacious argument:
Your school won "Outstanding Senior High School."
A company is recognized as the best employer in the country.
A basketball team became national champion.



Let's Analyze the Situation




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During a classroom debate on environmental protection, one student argues:

"Our school should completely ban single-use plastics because they contribute significantly to pollution.“

Another student replies:
"Why should we listen to you? Last month, I saw you using a plastic straw.



Ad Hominem (Against the Person)




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Instead of addressing the argument, the speaker attacks the **person's character, actions, or background.**

A logical argument should evaluate the **claim**, not the **individual making it**.

Create a fallacious argument:
Your classmate suggests implementing stricter classroom cleanliness rules.
A student proposes banning cellphones during class discussions.



Let's Analyze the Situation




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A group is deciding who should become the leader for their research project.

One member says:

"Vote for me as the leader. If you don't, I'll remove your names from the final presentation, and I'll tell the teacher you didn't help."

Appeal to Force (Argumentum ad Baculum)



This fallacy uses **threats, intimidation, or fear** to persuade others instead of presenting logical reasons or evidence.

Create a fallacious argument:
You want your classmates to vote for your proposed outreach project.
You want your younger sibling to lend you money.
A group leader wants everyone to agree with their research topic.



Let's Analyze the Situation





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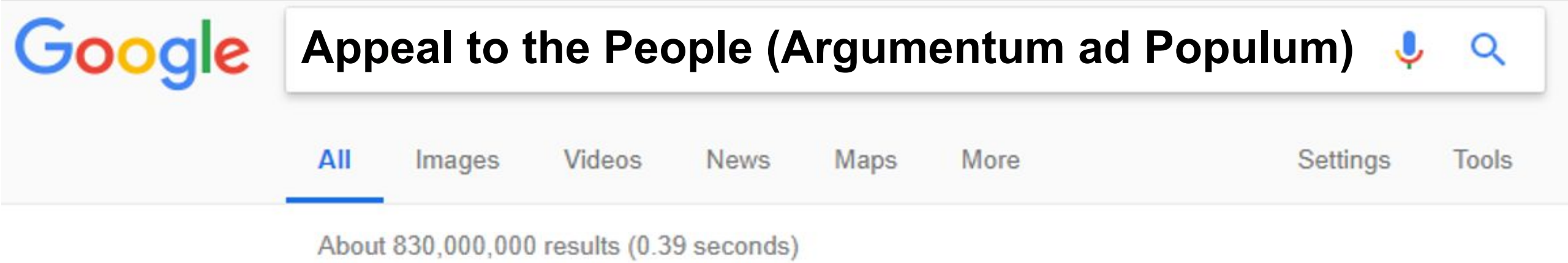
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A skincare product becomes viral after hundreds of influencers recommend it.

One student says:

"Millions of people bought it, so it must be safe and effective."

Appeal to the People (Argumentum ad Populum)



This fallacy assumes something is true, good, or correct **simply because many people believe or support it.**
Popularity is not the same as truth.

Create a fallacious argument:
A product becomes viral on TikTok.
Most students in school use AI to finish assignments.



Let's Analyze the Situation





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A student begins using a new pen before the quarterly examination.

After receiving the highest score in class, the student says:

"This pen is lucky. It helped me get the highest score!"



False Cause (Post Hoc)




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This fallacy assumes that **because one event happened before another, it must have caused it.**

Remember:
Correlation does not always mean causation.



Let's Analyze the Situation




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A Grade 12 student meets two graduates from a certain university who struggled to find jobs after graduation.

The student concludes:

"Graduates from that university don't get good jobs."



Hasty Generalization




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This fallacy occurs when someone draws a broad conclusion based on **too little or insufficient evidence.**

A few examples do not necessarily represent the whole group.



Let's Analyze the Situation

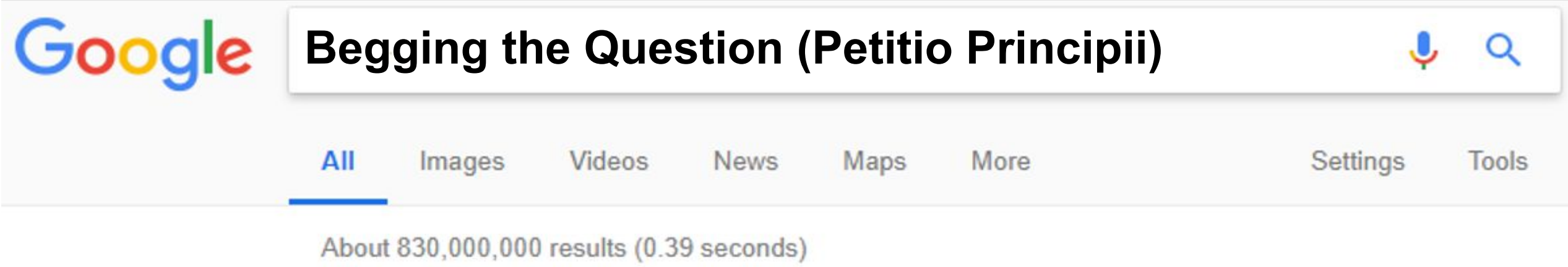



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During a class discussion, a student says:
"Our school rules are fair because the school always makes fair rules."

When the teacher asks for evidence, the student repeats:
"Because our rules are fair."



This fallacy occurs when **the conclusion is assumed within the premise**, resulting in **circular reasoning** instead of proof.

Example:
"Reading books is good because books are good to read."

The statement simply repeats the claim rather than providing evidence.



Let's Analyze the Situation




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The Student Council is planning activities for the school foundation day. During the meeting, one officer says:

"If you don't support our proposal for a school concert, then you don't care about making this year's foundation day successful.“

Some officers remain silent because they have different ideas, such as organizing academic competitions and community outreach programs.



False Dilemma (False Dichotomy / Either-Or Fallacy)



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This fallacy presents **only two choices** as if they are the only possible options, when in reality there are other alternatives.

Example 1
"If you don't join the Student Council, then you don't care about our school.“

Example 2
"Either you support the school policy, or you are against discipline.“

Example 3
"If you aren't studying all night, then you don't want to pass the exam."



Let's Analyze the Situation



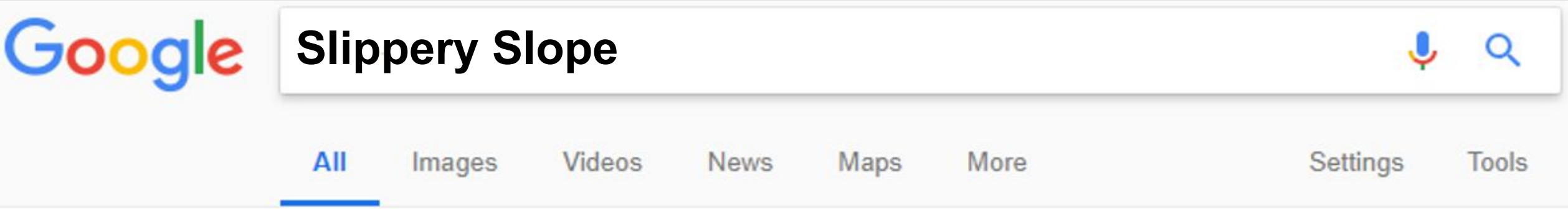

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The school administration is discussing whether students should be allowed to use smartphones during lunch break.

One teacher argues:

"If we allow students to use their phones during lunch, soon they'll use them during class, stop paying attention to lessons, fail their subjects, and eventually drop out of school."



This fallacy assumes that one action will inevitably lead to a series of increasingly serious consequences without sufficient evidence.

Key Idea:
Just because one event happens does not mean all the predicted consequences will automatically follow.

- "If students are allowed to use their phones during break time, eventually they'll use them during every class.“
- "If I skip one homework assignment, I'll fail the subject, repeat the grade, and never graduate."



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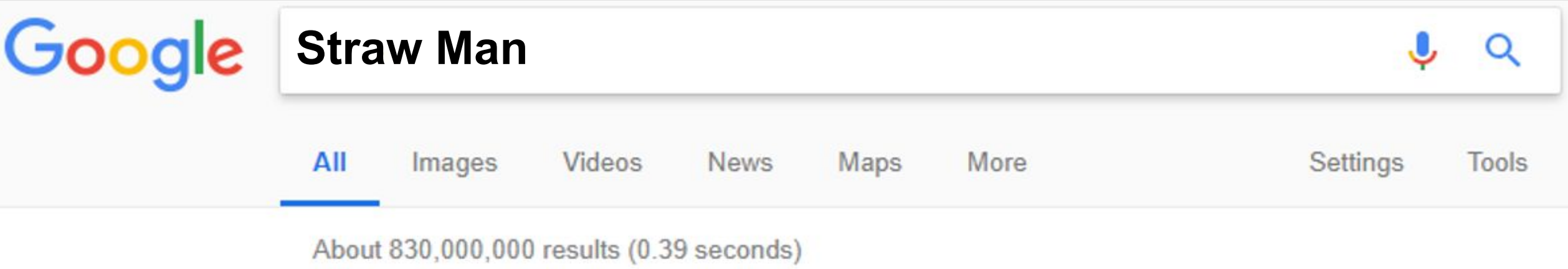
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During a class discussion about homework, a student says:
"I think teachers should reduce homework during examination week so students can better prepare for their tests.“

Another student responds:

"So you're saying teachers should stop giving homework completely. That's a terrible idea.“

The class becomes confused because that was not what the first student actually suggested.



This fallacy occurs when **someone misrepresents or exaggerates another person's argument, making it easier to criticize instead of addressing the original point.**

Key Idea:
Respond to what was **actually said**, not to a distorted version of it.

Student A:
"Students should use AI responsibly for learning."
Student B:
"So you're encouraging students to let AI do all their work."



Let's Analyze the Situation



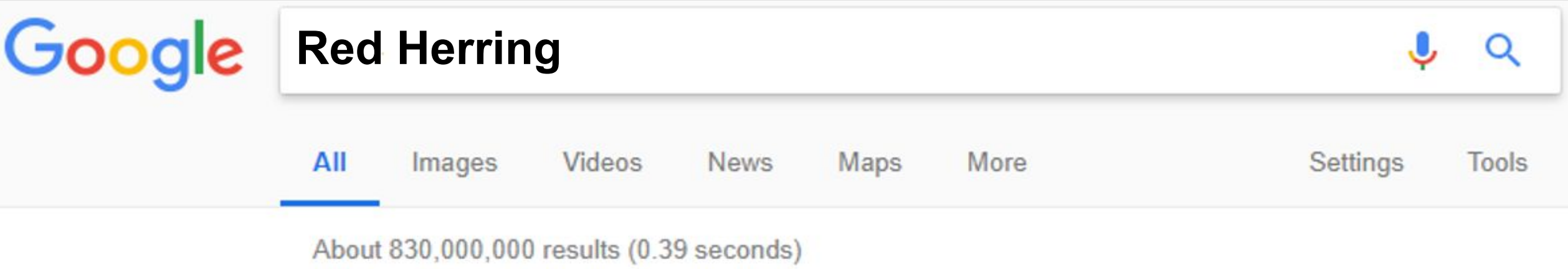

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A teacher asks a student:
"Can you explain why your research paper contains several paragraphs copied from online sources without proper citation?“

The student replies:
"Ma'am, our group stayed up all night working on this project, and we sacrificed a lot of our free time.“

The teacher notices that the student never answered the original question.



This fallacy occurs when someone introduces an unrelated topic to distract others from the main issue instead of addressing it directly.

Key Idea: Changing the subject does not answer the original question.

Parent:
"Why did you come home past your curfew?"
Student:
"But my grades have improved this quarter."

Fallacies Based on Emotion
Appeal to Pity (*Ad Misericordiam*)
Appeal to Force (*Ad Baculum*)
Appeal to the People (*Ad Populum*)

Fallacies Based on Faulty Evidence
Appeal to Ignorance (*Ad Ignorantiam*)
False Cause (*Post Hoc Ergo Propter Hoc*)
Hasty Generalization

Fallacies Based on Faulty Logic
Equivocation
Composition
Division
False Dilemma
Slippery Slope
Begging the Question

Fallacies That Misrepresent Arguments
Ad Hominem
Straw Man
Red Herring

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